

‘Openness’ can be applied throughout the innovation cycle

Innovation Lifecycle Stage	What Can Be Opened?	Examples of External Contributions
1. Opportunity Sensing & Problem Identification	Identifying unmet needs, trends, challenges, market gaps	Customers identifying pain points, lead users suggesting future needs, citizen feedback, industry advisory boards
2. Ideation & Concept Generation	Generating new ideas and concepts	Crowdsourcing, idea competitions, hackathons, open innovation challenges, employee suggestion schemes
3. Research & Knowledge Creation	Creating scientific, technical or market knowledge	University partnerships, joint research centers, open science initiatives, industry consortia
4. Design & Development	Designing and building solutions	Co-development with suppliers, startup collaborations, open-source development communities, technology alliances
5. Prototyping, Testing & Validation	Evaluating functionality and market acceptance	Beta users, living labs, pilot customers, user communities, citizen science projects
6. Commercialization & Go-to-Market	Bringing innovations to market	Licensing partners, distributors, franchisees, venture partners, commercialization agents
7. Diffusion & Adoption	Promoting awareness and uptake	User communities, influencers, professional associations, ecosystem partners, ambassadors
8. Scaling & Ecosystem Expansion	Expanding reach and capability	Platform developers, strategic alliances, channel partners, developer ecosystems, complementary product providers
9. Improvement & Evolution	Ongoing enhancement after launch	Customer feedback, communities of practice, open-source contributors, supplier innovation programs
10. Value Extraction & Renewal	Capturing value from existing innovations and reusing knowledge	Patent licensing, patent pools, spin-offs, technology transfer, open-sourcing legacy technologies